

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE GREATER MESSAGE OF LUKE 6:38

OUR SUBJECT: UNVEILING THE MEANING OF LUKE 6:38

Luke 6:38 Give, and [gifts] will be given to you; good measure, pressed down, shaken together, and running over, will they pour into [the pouch formed by] the bosom [of your robe and used as a bag]. For with the measure, you deal out [with the measure you use when you confer benefits on others], it will be measured back to you. AMP

THIS VERSE IS ABOUT GIVING – GIVING GIFTS

NOTE

THIS VERSE IS MOSTLY USED BY CHRISTIANS TO REFER TO THE GIVING AND RECEIVING OF MONEY / OF FINANCES.

Now it could include money and possessions because it falls under the category of gifts and giving.

BUT HOWEVER, IN READING THE FULL CONTEXT (in which this verse is located) **ITS PRIMARY MEANING IS NOT FINANCES BUT SOMETHING MUCH MORE.**

Mistakenly for years I just followed what everyone seemed to interpret this verse to mean money, finances and I MISSED its true meaning.

I WAS SURPRISED TO LEARN THAT VERSE 38 IS ABOUT SOWING OR GIVING - **GOODNESS, KINDNESS, GENEROSITY, MERCY, LOVE, FORGIVENESS, AND NOT JUDGEMENT, CONDEMNATION AND PREJUDGING.**

JESUS DISCOURSE.

In this passage it is the discourse of Jesus with his disciples and a crowd of people that had gathered - **Luke 6:17**

IT IS PRIMARILY REFERRING TO SPIRITUAL CHARACTERISTICS OF PEOPLES LIVES AND NOT MONEY AND POSSESSIONS.

IT'S ABOUT GIVING GIFTS THAT ARE OF A SPIRITUAL NATURE.

ATTRIBUTES THAT FOLLOWERS OF CHRIST SHOULD DISPLAY

THE SUBSTANCE OF WHAT JESUS SAID IN CHAPTER 6.

LOVE FOR ENEMIES

Luke 6:27 "But to you who are willing to listen, I say, love your enemies! Do good to those who hate you.

BLESS AND PRAY FOR THOSE THAT CURSE AND HURT YOU.

28 Bless those who curse you. Pray for those who hurt you.

DON'T RETALIATE BUT SHOW GRACE AND GENEROSITY.

29 If someone slaps you on one cheek, offer the other cheek also. If someone demands your coat, offer your shirt also.

GIVE TO ANYONE.

30 Give to anyone who asks; and when things are taken away from you, don't try to get them back.

DO TO OTHERS AS YOU WOULD LIKE DONE TO YOU.

31 Do to others as you would like them to do to you.

SHOW LOVE BEYOND THOSE WHO LOVE YOU.

32 "If you love only those who love you, why should you get credit for that? Even sinners love those who love them!

✳ **DO GOOD BEYOND THOSE WHO DO GOOD TO YOU.**

33 *And if you do good only to those who do good to you, why should you get credit? Even sinners do that much!*
NLT

✳ **DON'T PREJUDGE PEOPLE'S RESPONSES PRIOR TO LENDING MONEY.**

34 *And if you lend money only to those who can repay you, why should you get credit? Even sinners will lend to other sinners for a full return.*

✳ **LOVE YOUR ENEMIES - DO GOOD TO YOUR ENEMIES. LEND TO THEM WITHOUT EXPECTING REPAYMENT.**

35 *"Love your enemies! Do good to them. Lend to them without expecting to be repaid. Then your reward from heaven will be very great, and you will truly be acting as children of the Most High, for he is kind to those who are unthankful and wicked.*

✳ **WE MUST BE COMPASSIONATE LIKE YOUR HEAVENLY FATHER IS.**

36 *You must be compassionate, just as your Father is compassionate.*

✳ **DO NOT JUDGE OTHERS – DO NOT CONDEMN OTHERS – FORGIVE OTHERS**

37 *"Do not judge others, and you will not be judged. Do not condemn others, or it will all come back against you. Forgive others, and you will be forgiven.*

1. **GIVE A GIFT OF FORGIVENESS, LOVE, ACCEPTANCE, TOLERANCE, GRACE, COMPASSION, MERCY, GENEROSITY AND REFRAINING FROM JUDGING, CONDEMNING, REJECTING AND BEING PREJUDICED.**
2. THESE ARE THE KIND OF **GIFTS** THAT WE **GIVE** TO OTHERS AND ALSO THE KIND OF BLESSINGS AND PROSPERITY WE WILL RECEIVE AND ENJOY IN OUR LIVES
3. **AND THE GIFT THAT YOU GIVE – IS WHAT WILL RETURN TO YOU AND SO MUCH MORE THAT IT IS RUNNING OVER**
4. **AND THE AMOUNT THAT YOU GIVE (GENEROSITY) OF THESE KIND OF GIFTS WILL DETERMINE THE AMOUNT YOU GET BACK**

38 *Give, and you will receive. Your gift will return to you in full—pressed down, shaken together to make room for more, running over, and poured into your lap. The amount you give will determine the amount you get back."* NLT

Luke 6:36 You must be compassionate, just as your Father is compassionate. NLT

THE FOLLOWING COMMENTARY WE SHOULD EXAMINE.

COMMENTARY. By Stephen Sanders - CROSSWALK

What Luke 6:38 Really means by: "Give and it will be given to you".

■ **LET'S CONSIDER HOW INCREDIBLY DEEP THIS VERSE IS IN ITS PROPER CONTEXT.**

- IF WE TOTALLY **DELETED VERSE 38 FROM THIS PASSAGE,** THERE WOULD BE NO QUESTION THAT JESUS IS TALKING ABOUT FORGIVING OTHERS.
 - HE SAYS, "BE MERCIFUL... DON'T JUDGE... DON'T CONDEMN... FORGIVE" which is basically like saying the same thing over and over again.
 - **THEN HE DROPS THE VERB "GIVE."**
 - ✳ IS HE (out of nowhere), SUDDENLY TALKING ABOUT MONEY OR MATERIAL THINGS IN THIS CONVERSATION? – **NO**
 - JESUS IS INSTRUCTING THOSE WHO FOLLOW HIM **TO "GIVE" FORGIVENESS AND AN UNCONDEMNING ATTITUDE IN THE SAME AMOUNT WE DESIRE TO BE FORGIVEN.**
 - WE ARE TO BE AS MERCIFUL AS GOD IS TO US; while judging, condemning, and forgiving others in the same way we desire to be judged, condemned, and forgiven by God.
 - IT'S FREEING TO KNOW THAT GOD WANTS TO GIVE ME **MORE FORGIVENESS** THAN I CAN HANDLE.
 - **THE EASIEST WAY TO DO THIS IS BY MAKING IT A PRIORITY.**
 - YES... EVEN A HIGHER PRIORITY THAN MONEY!**
- End of commentary.

THIS IS WHAT WE CAN AND SHOULD DO.

- A. WE CAN FOCUS ON "GIVING" FORGIVENESS, LOVE ACCEPTANCE ETC TO THOSE AROUND US IN A WAY THAT IS PLEASING TO HIM.**
- B. WE HAVE AN OBLIGATION AND A PRIVILEGE OF GIVING LOVE, MERCY, COMPASSION, FORGIVENESS, GENEROSITY, TOLERANCE, ACCEPTANCE; AND REFRAINING FROM JUDGING, CONDEMNING, REJECTING AND BEING PREJUDICED.**
- C. LUKE 6:38 IS MEANT TO REFLECT THE TENOR AND CHRISTIAN ATTRIBUTES THAT JESUS TAUGHT AND ARE CONSISTENTLY PORTRAYED THROUGH A LARGER PORTION OF CHAPTER 6.**
- D. OF WHAT IS CONSIDERED TO BE ACCEPTED CHRISTIAN CHARACTER THEN LET US BE DETERMINED TO FULFILL that obligation and THE REAL MEANING OF LUKE 6:38 BY GIVING /SHOWING THOSE KIND OF "GIFTS" LISTED ABOVE.**

Amen – Ps Barry